

Sama Mushtaq

PROGRAM MANAGER. MECHANICAL ENGINEERING.

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I began in mechanical engineering at Wichita State and spent my first year out of school as a mechanical design engineer, producing the MEP designs for more than 50 building projects. Operations then became my career for a decade. I opened restaurants, ran a casino food and beverage operation of three outlets and 120 people, and founded two companies. I am completing the BS in Mechanical Engineering at the University of Cincinnati, with a focus in robotics and automation, in 2027, and I am open to technical, design, mechanical engineering, and program management roles in the Cincinnati and Dayton area.

Mechanical Design MEP Design and Load Calculations AutoCAD and Revit Trane TRACE LabVIEW and Data Acquisition
Test Procedures and Quality Documentation Program Management Requirements and Acceptance Criteria Vendor Management
Budget and P&L KPI Reporting Process Improvement

ENGINEERING AND TECHNICAL EXPERIENCE

RYGNeco Co-Founder and Program Lead

August 2024 to present

- Turned an e-waste field pilot into an operating model and a four-portal product program covering intake, testing, disposition, data destruction records, pricing, and client reporting. Directed an approximately \$11,500 vendor-built MVP.
- Wrote the intake, testing, grading, and data disposition procedures, aligned to NIST 800-88 with SHA-256 certificate verification. More than 400 laptops, desktops, and network devices have gone through them with zero OSHA recordables, including a verified 130-unit record set for a healthcare pilot client.

Mercor AI Annotator and Quality Reviewer, Contract

February 2026 to present

- Evaluate model-generated technical and business work against detailed rubrics, trace claims and calculations to the supplied evidence, and write pass or fail rationales. Promoted from Annotator to Quality Reviewer within weeks.

MKEC Engineering Mechanical Design Engineer

December 2019 to December 2020

- Produced MEP design documents for more than 50 commercial, residential, and modular projects, including load calculations and HVAC, plumbing, electrical, equipment, and airflow schedules in Trane TRACE, AutoCAD, and Revit.
- Standardized the firm's Revit families, templates, and repeatable details, cutting design time by about 25 percent, and resolved field conflicts against NEC, IMC, IPC, IECC, and ASHRAE 90.1 through site visits.

Wichita State University Student Assistant and Engineering Tutor

June 2015 to December 2016

- Tutored students in engineering, mathematics, and physics, reviewing units, assumptions, diagrams, and calculations, and supported academic administration and technical documentation.

ENGINEERING PROJECTS, WICHITA STATE UNIVERSITY

Vibration sensing and data acquisition

2016

Designed the sensor mounts, fixtures, and test setup for a multi-sensor early warning concept, wired the sensors, captured 1,022 samples across three channels in LabVIEW, and separated sensor faults from mounting and cabling effects.

Kite buggy design and structural analysis

2015

Shared the load, stress, and deflection analysis on a five-person team that sized a 29.7 pound 6061 aluminum frame for a ten foot drop case and speeds to 40 mph within a \$400 budget, then fabricated and tested it.

Shell and tube heat exchanger design study

2016

Sized a countercurrent water to oil exchanger from heat duty through Reynolds and Nusselt correlations and compared ten materials across a clean surface and two fouling conditions for area, length, and cost.

Research support

2015 to 2016

Thin-sample thermal conductivity method with Dr. Gisuk Hwang, biodiesel from used cooking oil with compression ignition engine tests, and collagen reinforced calcium phosphate bone cement specimens.

OPERATIONS LEADERSHIP

EPIC Brands Assistant General Manager to General Manager

July 2025 to December 2025

- Promoted to General Manager in four months. Led 70 hourly employees and six managers on a \$10 million scope, contributed to 20 to 25 percent year over year growth, and cut controllable costs about 10 percent through zero-based budgeting.
- Built an approximately \$800,000 private dining pipeline in six months and opened Whiskey Yard, hiring and training 30 employees. Bar revenue rose 18 percent.

Hard Rock Casino Cincinnati Operations Manager to Acting General Manager

January 2024 to January 2025

- Connected P&L, inventory, labor, overtime, and product mix data to manager reviews across three outlets, about \$17 million in combined P&L and 120 employees, about 80 of them union.
- Recovered about \$14,000 a month in beverage variance, held inventory variance under 1 percent, reduced labor cost 10 percent, and cut overtime by 14 hours a week. Alcohol mix rose from 13 to 22 percent and upsell conversion from 9 to 17 percent.

iTZCALi Tapas and Tequila Director of Operations and Launch Consultant

September 2022 to January 2024

- Coordinated a fixed deadline opening for a 300-seat restaurant across construction, licensing, vendors, menu, POS, staffing, training, and payroll, and recruited and trained about 60 employees.
- The restaurant generated \$165,000 in its first 14 days and served up to 600 covers in a night. Soft opening evidence cut the menu from 45 items to 12 and cocktail production from about two minutes to 30 seconds.

Napoli Italian Eatery Opening Manager and Operations Lead

March 2021 to September 2022

- Opened a 170-cover restaurant to full house service within 90 days, trained 30 team members, kept a 100 percent health inspection record, and improved average check 35 percent and repeat visits 40 percent.

Bella Luna Cafe General Manager and Multi-Unit Lead

May 2016 to June 2019

- Grew one cafe into a two-location operation with a \$3 million P&L and 80 employees, increased sales 20 percent over two years, and built the operating and training systems for the second location.

MAK Trading Founder and Program Lead, concurrent

November 2019 to present

- Built and operated a paid financial markets education community with a three-person founding team, covering brand, onboarding, a 48-page curriculum, member support, and a platform migration. Reached about 2,000 members at its peak and more than 1,200 cumulative paid subscribers.

EDUCATION

University of Cincinnati BS Mechanical Engineering, focus in Robotics and Automation, expected 2027. Admitted August 2026, Spring 2027 start.

Wichita State University Mechanical Engineering studies, 2012 to 2016. 103 credits, 3.4 GPA, Dean's List.

University of Wales Trinity Saint David Business foundation year, 2010 to 2011. 25 US credits, 3.47 GPA.

TOOLS AND LANGUAGES

Tools AutoCAD, Revit, Trane TRACE, LabVIEW, CATIA, Microsoft Excel and Power Query, KPI dashboards, Stripe reporting, WordPress

Languages English, Urdu, and Hindi